

CASE STUDY

They built a 13,000-member site around two day jobs

How SENSible SENCO grew from a Facebook group into a membership platform for UK special education staff.

SWIPE →

THE START

It began as a Facebook group.

During the pandemic, Abigail and Gavin Hawkins started a group to help special education coordinators. It grew from a few hundred people to **6,000 members**.

THE MOVE

From a group to their own site.

They rebuilt it on WordPress with Paid Memberships Pro so they owned the platform. It now supports **13,000 members**.

THE MODEL

They reinvest every penny.

SENsible SENCO runs as a Community Interest Company and **reinvests all of its revenue** into resources and training. Membership is £15/month, or £199/year for a school.

THE REALITY

All of this, after hours.

Both founders hold full-time jobs. They run the platform on **clear goals and tight time management**, leaning on the community to keep it moving.

THE TAKEAWAY

**You can build
this around the
job you have.**

Abigail was recently invited to advise
Parliament's Education Select
Committee on the SEND system. It
started as a side project.

Read the full case study →